Same tools. Different results.

Your company has rolled out the same AI as everyone else. Inside, results vary person by person, and so does what people believe AI can and can't do. **AI Builders gives a team one shared understanding of how AI works, one set of working practices, and the confidence to rebuild its own work around them.**



Teaching DoorDash's analytics organization at its offsite in Seattle, August 2025.

14 cohorts over two and a half years	**3,000+** paid learners	**5.0 / 5** 87 ratings on Maven	**DoorDash · Pinterest · LinkedIn · Amazon Tencent · Meituan · Xiaohongshu** team trainings, workshops, and briefings

More than half of our learners work at leading technology companies, including **OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, Meta, and Amazon.**

FOR THE PEOPLE DECIDING

Rolling out the tools was the easy part.

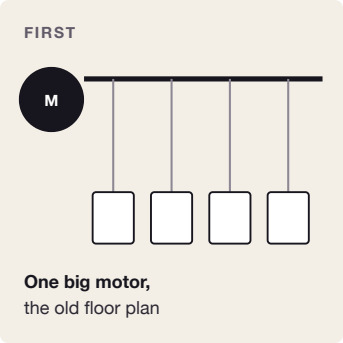
What we hear from the leaders who bring us in, what changes once their team trains together, and where to see the evidence.

	WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT CHANGES	THE EVIDENCE
01	Everyone learned AI on their own, so everyone has a different theory of what it can do.	One shared technical understanding and one set of standard practices: state the outcome, supply the context, set acceptance criteria, check the result. People speak the same language, your strongest users stop re-teaching, and work can be handed off without a walkthrough.	**A five-line rules file took two models to 28 of 28 right on the first try.** Experiment · page 5
02	Half the team over-trusts polished output. The other half wrote AI off after one bad try.	A calibrated sense of what AI can and can't do today, reasoned from how it works rather than from headlines, and the habit of telling an answer that looks right from one that is right.	**"I used to think that many scenarios were beyond AI's capabilities."** A Microsoft applied scientist · page 7. Our own graded predictions · page 6
03	"AI doesn't work on our data."	Most bad results are a method problem, not a model problem: missing context, no definition of done, the wrong layer fixed. People learn to diagnose before they blame, and to put their effort where it pays.	**Live at DoorDash: same AI, same prompt. Wrong answer, then one document fixed, right answer.** Demo and experiment · page 5
04	People are anxious, or quietly opting out.	The fear of no longer being needed, old learning habits, and goals too vague to act on give way to small things finished early. People learn that crude tools mean the era is early, not that they are bad at this.	**Learners at Google, TikTok, and Microsoft describe the shift in their own words.** Public reviews · page 7
05	Everyone is faster. The team isn't.	Workflows, reviews, and metrics priced for an era of expensive execution get recomputed. People own results end to end, and specialists ship tools colleagues can use instead of answering one-off requests.	**Six beliefs from the last era. People approving each step caught 13.6% of dangerous commands.** Pages 3 and 5

How you'll know it worked. A few weeks after training, each person has one finished thing in use, has got unstuck on their own at least once, and can pick up a colleague's project without a walkthrough. Page 8.

Some of your best practices were priced for a different era.

Every best practice carries the price list of its time. Code was expensive, so we reused it. Observation was expensive, so we sampled. Execution was expensive, so we met before acting. AI changed the prices. The hardest part is unlearning: newcomers don't know what works; experts know too well what used to.



When factories first electrified, many swapped the steam engine for one big electric motor and kept the old floor plan: one drive shaft, belts to every machine. Productivity barely moved. The gains came decades later, once factories were redesigned around a small motor at each machine.

Bolting AI onto an old workflow is the big-motor stage. Training has to reach the floor plan.

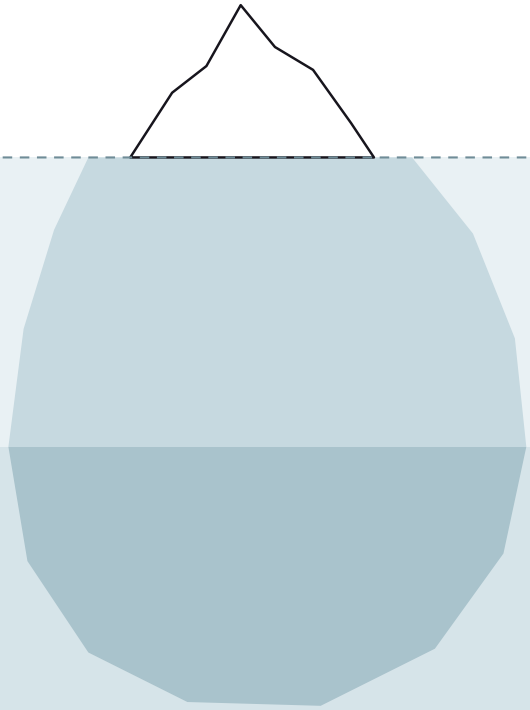
Yan told this story at DoorDash's analytics offsite. The history is documented in Paul David's "The Dynamo and the Computer."

	THE OLD BELIEF	WHAT WE SEE NOW
1	~~More AI usage means more value.~~	Activity, tokens, and tool counts all go up. **Dropped into the wrong process, AI amplifies the mess.**
2	~~Faster code is better code.~~	Code still has to serve the business and be maintained. **Generating gets cheaper; getting adopted is what gains value.**
3	~~Individual productivity adds up to team productivity.~~	Everyone feels faster, but **the handoffs, interfaces, and evaluation around them weren't rebuilt.**
4	~~Productivity gains turn into profit.~~	Unit costs fall. **Demand that people will pay for is still scarce.**
5	~~Knowing the concepts means understanding AI.~~	Anyone can explain RAG or MCP. **Nouns are snapshots; real work is continuous,** and that is where the judgment lives.
6	~~Owning a result means checking every step yourself.~~	Owning it now means **checks that scale**: acceptance criteria, independent review, and people on the decisions only people can make.

Beliefs 1–5 come from our session for Tencent's engineering teams; belief 6 from our writing on AI-native work.

Answers are free now. Judgment isn't.

Anyone on your team can ask AI what RAG or MCP means and get a clear answer in seconds. What separates people who get reliable work out of AI sits below the surface, where tutorials don't reach. The course gives a team the same picture of that layer, and the practice to build it.



ABOVE THE SURFACE · FREE AND COPYABLE

Prompts, tools, tutorials, RAG, MCP, agents

AI explains them in seconds. Anyone can copy them. They change every month.

WATERLINE

BELOW · WHAT DECIDES THE RESULT

Technical intuition

What to give AI, where it will break, what to check.

Product intuition

What is worth building, for whom, and what good looks like.

DEEPEST · WHERE THAT JUDGMENT COMES FROM

A world model

Your grasp of causes, incentives, and constraints, sharpened by predictions that reality can grade.

Craft

What you can see before you can explain it. Built only by doing.

"Knowing what RAG is lives above the water. Knowing you don't need it this time lives below."

HOW THE COURSE BUILDS IT · FOUR MODULES, EACH ON THE LEARNER'S OWN WORK

1 · Say what done looks like

~~AI misses, so you reword the prompt again.~~

You define a good result before AI starts. Less rework, fewer errors.

2 · Give it your context

~~Every new chat starts with re-explaining everything.~~

Names, rules, and your own judgment live in files AI reads every time.

3 · Check it like a manager

~~AI is right eight times in ten; you hunt for the other two line by line.~~

You know it is right without rereading it all, and hand over an hour of work against acceptance criteria.

4 · Choose it, build it

~~You take whichever plan a tutorial or AI offers.~~

You tell plausible from reliable, pick something worth doing, and build it for real users.

HOW IT RUNS

Two 2-hour live workshops over two weeks, an optional 90-minute office hour, five guided projects (about six hours), then a capstone of 5–30 hours with feedback.

WHO IT IS FOR

Technical and non-technical roles alike. Learners direct AI in plain language instead of writing code by hand, and every one of them builds: this is a craft, like swimming, and nobody learns it from the poolside.

CLAIMS WE TEST BEFORE WE TEACH

We show our numbers.

We test a method before we teach it: change one thing, hold everything else, grade against an answer key. Four results a team lead can use. The raw runs of our own experiments are public.

Same AI, same prompt. One document changed.

Live demo at DoorDash's analytics offsite, on a mock campaign analysis: did the program lift order value?

ACT 1 · THE WIKI PAGE IS OUT OF DATE

~~"0% lift"~~

Wrong, and stated with confidence. The page pointed AI at a retired table and the wrong join key.

ACT 3 · ONE NEW DATA-MODEL DOCUMENT

"60% lift"

Correct. AI wrote the document from the live database; a person added the one thing it couldn't find, the metric's new definition.

"AI doesn't work on our data" is usually a documentation problem. The fix was one reusable document, and AI flagged the stale page on its own.

Yan Wang at DoorDash's analytics offsite, August 2025. Demo on mock data.

Describe the destination, not the steps

A 55-minute meeting recorded in two files that overlap by 40 seconds, with a quiet phone participant. Same top model, six runs each way (three in English, three in Chinese).

Following its own detailed 16-step plan



0 of 6 met every requirement

Given five acceptance criteria instead



6 of 6

Every check in a step list checks the list's own assumptions. All six plans assumed the files didn't overlap. Given only the destination, the model found the overlap itself.

AI Builders course text, lesson 3.7. Raw runs and prompts

One page of shared rules

28 voice memos, each cleaned up in a fresh session with the same one-line request. The only change: a five-line rules file. Memos right on the first try:

DeepSeek V4.1 Flash



22 without the file

28 of 28 with it

Gemini 3.8 Flash



18 without the file

28 of 28 with it

Standard practices aren't bureaucracy. Written down once, they make every run reliable. On Chinese memos the same two models went from 10 and 4 right to 28 and 25.

AI Builders course text, lesson 2.4. Raw runs and the rules file

Approving every step is false control

Anthropic's study with 1,053 professional testers: dangerous commands slipped into an AI coding session. Share caught:

People approving each command

13.6%

Automated classifier



89%

In everyday use, people approve 97% of permission prompts.

Put people on direction and plans, not on clicking approve. Owning a result now means checks that scale: criteria, independent review, and human attention where it counts.

Anthropic, 2026; taught in AI Builders lesson 3.8.

Hype we checked. When multi-agent setups became the default advice, Yan worked through the public benchmarks: on one, a team of agents added 7.3 points, while simply raising a single model's reasoning effort added 11.4.

JUDGMENT ON THE RECORD

We write our calls down, with odds.

In February 2023, before GPT-4, Yuzheng wrote down six bets about what ChatGPT would do within two years, each with a probability; the English version ran that March. Here is how reality graded them, plus one call from January 2025.

	THE BET	ODDS	RESULT	WHAT HAPPENED
1	Expert-level answers to factual questions	99%	Yes	o1 beat PhD experts on a science benchmark (2024)
2	Expert-level answers to judgment questions	80%	Mostly	About half of ChatGPT messages seek information or advice (2025)
3	A digital copilot for everyone	70%	Yes	800 million weekly ChatGPT users (2025)
4	Programming ten times more efficient; a small team ships a AAA game in six months	60%	Partly	Coding agents, yes; AAA in six months, no
5	A digital apprentice that out-earns him	50%	Not yet	
6	An article full of original knowledge	5%	No	His book still needed him for that
’25	Agents are the next shift, with a 10–18 month window for early movers		Yes	Claude Code and Codex became the main way builders work

The likely bets landed; the long shots didn’t. What he got wrong, by his own 2025 postscript: he overestimated OpenAI, and how fast models would improve. The dated records, with sources: lizheng.ai/en · English version, March 2023

2023 · YUZHENG

Inference will get about a hundred times cheaper.

GPT-4 cost $30 per million tokens in 2023. GPT-4o mini, which beat it in chat, cost $0.15 in 2024.

2023 · YUZHENG

A model’s best way to use knowledge is search, not retraining.

Retrieval and context became the default. In the course: models are rented, context is owned.

MARCH 2025 · YAN

To learn agentic AI, first forget every framework.

Sixteen days later came “The Underrated Claude Code.” Claude Code then took off.

Two kinds of judgment, taught together

What is true → what is worth doing → how to make it happen reliably



Yuzheng Sun, PhD

What is worth building, and who owns the result.

Cornell PhD in Economics. Economist at Amazon, data scientist at Meta, Vice Director of Data & AI at Tencent IEG, Principal Data Scientist at Statsig (later acquired by OpenAI). Co-organizer of AI Engineer Shanghai.



Yan Wang, PhD

Why models work, why they fail, and how to make systems reliable.

Columbia PhD in Electrical Engineering. Nearly 40 papers across CVPR, NeurIPS, KDD, and other venues; 3,000+ citations. Creator of the open-source devin.cursorrules.

BEHIND THE COURSE 14 cohorts in two and a half years, rebuilt for Cohort 14 in October 2026 · course text rewritten in English and Chinese, November 2026 · a community of 30,000+ members and 900+ shared projects · 150+ recorded conversations with operators and researchers

SEE IT BEFORE YOU DECIDE

Read what we taught inside other companies.

Slides from our company sessions are public, page by page. Open the one closest to your team and judge the teaching yourself.

LinkedIn Engineering leadership briefing	Common misconceptions in AI transformation for engineering teams AI adoption is not transformation. What has to change is how a team builds, evaluates, and learns.	Slides · English
Amazon AI agent workshop	Stop chatting, start scaling From one-off chats to agent loops with context, evaluation, and standards that survive the first request.	Slides · English
DoorDash Analytics offsite	How to manage context so AI does high-quality work The demo on page 5: why AI fails on undocumented data, and how analysts become navigators instead of rowers.	Recording · 25 min English · on request
Pinterest Data Science Weekly	AI breaks data science's impossible triangle Speed, scale, and explainability used to be pick-two. A live build on synthetic data delivers all three.	Recording · 58 min English · on request
Tencent Engineering series	Common mistakes in an engineering team's AI transition Why individual speed doesn't become team speed, and what has to be rebuilt.	Slides · Chinese

Also delivered: company-wide sessions at Meituan and at Xiaohongshu (for operations, content, commercial, product, and brand teams). All public decks: lizheng.ai/en/decks

IN LEARNERS' WORDS · PUBLIC MAVEN REVIEWS, 5.0 / 5 FROM 87 RATINGS

"Despite I was working on AI tools day-to-day, I find myself learning something new and in a deeper level."

Chairy · UX Manager, **Google**

"I used to think that many scenarios were beyond AI's capabilities… Now, thinking about how to use AI to solve problems has become a habit for me."

TT · Applied Scientist, **Microsoft**

"This course is highly valuable no matter your background (technical or non technical, like me)… I've already noticed a mindset shift at work."

Julia · Strategy Ops Manager, **TikTok**

"I waited a couple of months before sharing feedback because I wanted to see how things actually held up in practice… I've been able to apply what I learned here directly to my job."

Ying · Principal Engineer

"There are many courses teaching you specific tricks but this course helps you build the right mindset and empower you to teach yourself more effectively."

Shuyang · Member of Technical Staff, **OpenAI** · former Sr. AI Manager, Uber

"There can be different new tools coming, but principles remain!"

EZ · Engineer, **Anthropic**

Reviews are quoted as written and shortened with ellipses. Employers identify the reviewers and do not imply company endorsement.

WAYS TO WORK TOGETHER

Start with the simplest step that solves the problem.

01	**Working session**	One real question with your leads: what result you want, which assumptions to test, and what the right next step is.	**From $2,000**
02	**Team seats in a scheduled cohort**	Your people join a live Maven cohort alongside professionals from other companies. Next cohort: Feb 15 – Mar 1, 2027.	**$1,999 per learner** 2–9 learners: 20% off ($1,599.20) 10+ learners: 25% off ($1,499.25)
03	**Private cohort**	The same course for your organization only, on dates we set together.	**From $44,977.50** 30+ learners · $1,499.25 each
04	**Course customization**	Your cases, data, and exercises, when they change what the team needs to learn.	**From $20,000** in addition to tuition
05	**Fully custom program**	We study the roles, workflows, materials, and evaluation first, then design the program, the delivery, and the tools your team keeps.	**From $100,000**
+	**Self-paced plan**	AI Builders and AI Architect in English, plus all four courses in Chinese. No live sessions. Every future update is included, so buying now includes the Nov–Dec 2026 refresh. With 12 months of Stay Superlinear membership.	**$1,048 per learner** $1,299 from Jan 1, 2027

COHORTS INCLUDE Two 2-hour live workshops and an optional 90-minute office hour · five guided projects · a capstone of 5–30 hours with feedback · lifetime access to 100+ lessons and all future updates · certificate of completion · one year of Stay Superlinear membership.

The test we hold ourselves to

1. Does each person have one finished thing that is in use?
2. Has each person, at least once, got unstuck on their own?
3. Can someone pick up a colleague's project and change it without a walkthrough?

Ask these a few weeks after training. If the answers are no, the training didn't do its job.

Tell us what should be different afterwards.

Send the team, the problem today, the result you want to change, and rough timing. We'll recommend a starting point and send a quote.

Email yz@superlinear.academy
Course maven.com/superlinear/aibuilders
Formats lizheng.ai/en/collab/enterprise

Prices in USD, before applicable taxes. Cohort prices, team discounts, and dates follow Maven's settings as of November 12, 2026. The self-paced price changes at 00:00 on January 1, 2027, Beijing time; final terms are shown at checkout, and invoices for approval are available on request. Private cohorts, customization, and custom programs are subject to instructor availability and a mutually executed order form that sets final scope, schedule, payment, cancellation terms, and taxes. Quotes are valid for 30 days. Companies named are public trainings, workshops, briefings, and internal sessions; custom engagements are named only with client permission. Company materials used in private or custom work stay with the engagement and are never published without permission. Experiments cited from our course text use the models named at the time of writing.